

Ioana **Frîncu**

Technical Product Manager • Technical AI Safety • AI Platforms & MLOps

Brussels, Belgium · Willing to relocate

(+32) 456390234 | f_ioana@tuta.com | flifenstein.com | flifenstein | frincui | Ioana Frincu

"Something will go wrong. The question is whether you measured it."

Summary

Industry Technical Product Manager and team **"glue worker"** at imec's SiliconAI group (ex-Microsoft AI for Good Lab PM) with the inside view of production LLM inference systems that safety research rarely has. Currently building agentic inference benchmarking on SWE-Bench coding tasks; MSc thesis cited in Abdulhai et al. 2025 on LLM deception.

Research

Iris.AI (in collaboration with Aalto University)

Remote

Research Intern — NLP / LLM Evaluation — *Feb. 2023 – Sep. 2023 (8 mo)*

- Master Thesis "In search of the perfect prompt". Ran a human-subject evaluation study on soft vs. hard prompt-tuning techniques for LLM-generated scientific abstracts — cited in Abdulhai et al. 2025 (Berkeley/Oxford) on reducing LLM deception via multi-turn RL — with hands-on **LLM fine-tuning, prompt engineering, and human-AI evaluation methodology**. Designed study protocol, recruited participants, and analyzed qualitative and quantitative measures of output utility across prompting strategies.

Work Experience

Technical Product Manager

Ghent, Belgium

imec · SiliconAI — *May 2026 – Present*

- Scoped and led **SiliconAI's agentic inference benchmarking framework** measuring system-level latency, memory pressure, and scheduling behavior under realistic agentic workloads (SWE-Bench coding tasks) across GPU and CPU deployments.
- Leading a 10-person (AI SWEs and researchers) team across 3 parallel tracks.

AI Platform Product Owner

Ghent, Belgium

OpenChip — *Nov. 2025 – Apr. 2026*

- Owned product Booster, a multi-tenant LLM inference platform on **KServe and vLLM**. I served as central decision-maker for a team of 6 senior engineers, closing architecture decisions autonomously including shared vs. unique tenant identity in multi-tenant deployments, without requiring leadership escalation.
- Unblocked a 2-week long beta-scope deadlock by shipping a working Claude Code **prototype** for Booster in under two days, forcing concrete product decisions. Introduced the Agile structure in the team from my second week, because there were none.

Product Management Intern — AI for Good Lab

Brussels / Remote

Microsoft — *Mar. 2025 – Nov. 2025*

- End-to-end launch of **LINGUA**, a Microsoft AI4G Lab **grant program** funding open-licensed datasets for underrepresented European languages; 11 projects selected across 16 languages and 10 countries.
- Shipped an internal AI storytelling tool built to streamline research-to-impact reporting across lab projects.

Jr. Product Owner

Leuven, Belgium

Twipe Digital Publishing — *Oct. 2023 – Mar. 2025*

- Delivered a **multi-title feature for Centre France mobile app** on a 21-Man-Days budget: coordinated stack migration, UX improvements, release monitoring, and post-release triage across a multi-brand app merge
- Replaced expensive manual QA with **automated E2E testing**; owned platform releases across mobile and web.

Skills

AI / ML	Model serving, LLM fine-tuning, prompt engineering, RAG, human–AI evaluation; Claude & OpenAI APIs, Hugging Face, Ollama
Product	Product strategy, 0-to-1 scoping, roadmap & prioritization, technical specs, stakeholder alignment, Agile
Programming	Python, SQL, R, JavaScript & TypeScript, React, TailwindCSS, Kubernetes, Jenkins
UX	Figma, Claude Code, Lovable, InDesign, qualitative and quantitative user research
Languages	English (C2), Romanian (C2), Dutch (B2), French (A2)

Education

MSc, Human-Computer Interaction & Design — Double Degree

Netherlands & Finland

EIT Digital Master School

Sep. 2021 – Sep. 2023

- University of Twente (Year 1) + Aalto University (Year 2). Minor in Innovation & Entrepreneurship. Technical coursework: Machine Learning, NLP, Conversational Agents (incl. Advanced Project), Speech Processing, Affective Computing, Product Management, Computer Ethics.
- **Thesis** on LLM prompt-tuning evaluation (Aalto repository; cited in Abdulhai et al. 2025), conducted with Iris.ai.

BSc, Communication Science

Netherlands

University of Twente

Sep. 2017 – Sep. 2021

- Coursework: digital marketing, UX, persuasive technology, statistics & R, media studies.

Courses

May. 2026 **BlueDot**, Technical AI Safety — *Online*

Feb. 2026 **Turing AI Ethics**, Turing College — *Online*

Community & Extracurricular

Co-founder

Brussels, Belgium

Women in AI Belgium

Jan. 2026 – May. 2026

- Founding ambassador for the Belgian chapter, organizing community events and knowledge-sharing sessions on AI-related topics.

Board Member — External Affairs

Enschede, Netherlands

Study Association Communiqué

Sep. 2019 – Oct. 2020

Led an NGO study association for a year while studying full time. Built industry partnerships for Career Fair, Symposium, and company visits; secured €4,000 in sponsorships.